

Yeoford Village Voice

Distributed free to homes in Yeoford and District, Devon

December 2025

Issue 416



www.theduckatyeoford.co.uk



The
Duck
at Yeoford

This month: Holidays are Coming! Holidays are Coming! Yeo!Cider Write-Up! Craft Fest! The Duck's Golden Eggs! And much, much more...

Contact Details

LOCAL ORGANISATIONS/CLUBS ETC.

YEOFORD COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

Chair: Carl Wholey

Bookings: yeoford.hall@gmail.com 01363 84501

YEOFORD RECREATION GROUND

Warden: David Lucking 01363 84988

YEOFORD HOLY TRINITY CHURCH

Contact: Carol Price 01647 24468

YEOFORD PRIMARY SCHOOL

Contact: School Administrator 01363 84234

YEOFORD FOUNDATION STAGE UNIT

Contact: Administrator 01363 84234

YEOFORD CRICKET CLUB

Captain: Paul Coren 01363 84238

YEOFORD 200 C£UB

Contact: club200yeoford@outlook.com

CREDITON HAMLETS PARISH COUNCIL

Chairman: John Stevens 07968169274

Clerk: Charlotte Long

clerk@creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk

THE YEOFORD VILLAGE VOICE TEAM

Editor:

Jonathan Rogers 01363 84501

yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk

Advertising:

Di Parsons 01363 84155

diparsons9876@gmail.com

Everything else:

David Lucking 01363 84988

USEFUL CONTACTS

POLICE

101 in a non-Emergency

999 in an Emergency

0800 555111 Crimestoppers

0800 405040 Transport Police

EMERGENCIES

105 Electricity Failure

0845 9881188 EA Floodline

0800 807060 Environment Hotline

0800 111999 Gas Emergency

0800 1691144 Water Leaks/Burst Mains

0845 1551004 Roads/Street Lights

0310 1234999 RSPCA

0845 6000388 Social Services

MEDICAL

01363 772227 Redlands Primary Carey

01647 24272 Cheriton Bishop Surgery

111 NHS Choices (non-Emergency)

01363 775588 Crediton Hospital

01363 772062 Boots Pharmacy

01363 773030 Crediton Pharmacy

01363 772841 Lloyds Pharmacy

C159X Yeoford Defibrillator Code

No Code Required Duck Defibrillator

SCHOOLS

01363 84234 Yeoford Primary

01363 773401 QE Academy Trust

OTHERS

01363 778410 Citizens Advice

0845 7484950 National Rail Enquiries

01363 85273 The Duck at Yeoford

01363 773303 Crediton Ring and Ride

COUNCILS/MP

0345 155 1015 Devon County Council

01884 255255 Mid Devon District Council

0207 2197037 Mel Stride MP

mel.stride.mp@parliament.uk

The Village Voice Really Needs You...

The Yeoford Village Voice relies on advertising and donations to ensure that it goes to press each month. To advertise in the Village Voice and reach over 600 people locally:

Monthly Charges

Full Page...£20 Half Page...£15

Quarter...£8 Eighth...£4

Please contact **Di** on

01363 84155 [diparsons9876@gmail.com] to discuss your requirements.

Editorial

Tis the Season to be Jolly!

So, here we are, December already, November came, got cold, got warm again, got wet and went. Probably for the best, it's always a fairly dismal month. Anyway, the festive season is upon us, hurrah! The thought of a few days off is really quite welcome...and the thought of days getting longer, oh the joy!

Anyway, what's been going on? Well, not an awful lot. We've had a bit of flooding. We've got a lot of mud and leaves on the roads. We've had some ice. We've had some potholes appear and then get swiftly filled in. And that's about it.

This month, it's obviously getting a bit Christmassy and that includes the return of the Christmas Lights Competition, details of that inside.

In other news, you'll be more than aware of the funding issues that the VV has had over the past year with printing costs going up once again. We were pleased to get support from the Parish Council and are now incredibly grateful to Jim Cairney for providing support from DCC's Locality Fund. This basically keeps us afloat temporarily. That said, we haven't raised advertising rates for, ahem, at least 18 years, during which printing has quadrupled, so we will be rectifying that in the new year. As ever any donations are gratefully received...

There's also going to be changes afoot with the look of the VV as MS Publisher is disappearing. A chance for a refresh maybe?!

Anyway, that's all, have a great Christmas and New Year...until next year!

Cheers...

The Editor

The Village Voice Is YOUR Village Magazine

We want to hear from you and want you to use it to convey anything you feel of interest to your fellow villagers.

Please leave any items for the YVV at Torricon, Station Road before the **20th of each month**, anything after that date may not be considered until the following month. **You must provide a name and address**, even if this is not for publication.

You can also email the editor, Jonathan, at **yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk** or phone **01363 84501**

Publishing date: **the first week of each month.**

The Village Voice accepts no responsibility for any of the information or contributions contained herein.



Local Information

YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL

COMMUNITY HALL CHARGES (hourly rate)

	Trustee User Groups	Local Community Groups	Private Bookings (Local)	Private Bookings (Non Local)
Main Hall (includes kitchen)	£3.00	£5.00	£8.00	£10.00
Meeting Room (includes kitchen)	£2.00	£3.00	£3.50	£5.50
Party/Wedding 24hr hire	—	—	£150	£250
Party/Wedding 48hr hire	—	—	£400	£500

Exclusive field use, BBQ, Stage, Disco Equipment also available.

For bookings, please e-mail yeoford.hall@gmail.com
Or phone: 01363 84501

The latest hall calendar can be found at
www.yeoford.org/community-hall

The will be no meeting or coffee morning in December as members will be gearing up for Christmas lunch and other seasonal frivolities. Normal will resume in January.



* Yeoford Community Garden *
* Yeoford Community Hall now has an area *
* dedicated to providing a small community *
* garden. Any villagers are welcome to get *
* involved in running and maintaining the *
* garden. *
* Please speak to **Dee Hawkins** or email *
* yeoford.hall@gmail.com for further *
* information. *

Top Tip!

Get your own back on people whose car has 'blinding' headlights, by glueing a full-length mirror horizontally to the front of your motor.

PUNCHBOWL RECYCLING CENTRE

OPEN 7 DAYS A WEEK

MON-FRI: 09:00 - 16:30
SAT & SUN: 10:00 - 16:30

TRAINTIMES FROM YEOFORD

NB: Yeoford is a Request Stop

TO BARNSTAPLE

Mon -Fri	Sat	Sun
	0540	
0630	0633	
0725	0730	
0834	0837	
0937	0937	0938
1037	1037	1039
1137	1137	1138
1237	1238	1238
1337	1337	1335
1437	1438	1435
1537	1537	1536
1637	1637	1637
1738	1739	1736
1841	1844	1836
1943	1947	1938
2041	2043	2037
2147	2145	
2313		
Fo		

TO EXETER

Mon -Fri	Sat	Sun
0708	0713	
0813	0816	
0918	0921	
1019	1018	1017
1117	1117	1117
1216	1216	1221
1319	1319	1317
1417	1417	1417
1516	1516	1519
1617	1617	1614
1719	1720	1718
1822	1825	1818
1924	1930	1917
2023	2026	2017
2124	2123	2119
2227	2224	2226
2320	2320	
Fx		
2352		
Fo		

Fx – Monday-Thursday
Fo – Friday only
For more details, go to
GWR.com/timetables



Bus Timetables

677 (Fridays only)

Dartline Coaches

Zeal Monachorum Church	0912
Coleford Gospel Hall	0927
Colebrooke Church	0932
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	0936
YEO VIEW	0938
Raddon Down Cross	0945
Crediton TIC High Street	0955
Exeter Sidwell Street	1020

Exeter Sidwell Street	1320
Crediton TIC High Street	1345
Raddon Down Cross	1350
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1355
YEO VIEW	1357
Colebrooke Church	1403
Coleford Gospel Hall	1408
Zeal Monachorum Church	1423

669 (Tuesdays only)

MD Buses

South Zeal Oxenham Arms	0915
Whiddon Down Shelter	0922
Hittisleigh Cross	0930
Crockernwell	0945
Cheriton Bishop School	0947
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1002
Colebrooke Church	1010
Coleford Gospel Hall	1013
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1022
Crediton Morrisons	1027

Crediton Morrisons	1115
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1235
Coleford Gospel Hall	1244
Colebrooke Church	1247
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1255
Cheriton Bishop School	1310
Crockernwell	1313
Hittisleigh Cross	1326
Whiddon Down Shelter	1328
South Zeal Oxenham Arms	1335

YEOFORD POST OFFICE

Friday 3:15-4:15pm in the Community Hall

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Contact: CHUDLEIGH POST OFFICE; TEL: 01626 852149





Firstly, we were absolutely delighted to receive news at the end of October that we had been included in the Good Food Guide's top 100 pubs in Great Britain. This was a real surprise to us and made even more special by the fact it was based on nominations by our wonderful customers, these nominations were then followed by an inspection. So a huge thank you so those of you that nominated us.

Now onto Christmas and New Year - James has once again been making his delicious Christmas Puddings, Large £10.95 and Small £6.95 Vegetarian and GF available. He has also made some yummy Christmas fudge - Brandy and Sultana, available in 200g bags.

We are now taking bookings for the Christmas Day Takeaway, as last year this will be £80.00 for two people. Collect on Christmas Eve and include - Roast Breast and Stuffed Leg of British Turkey, Duck Fat Potatoes, Honey Roast Carrots and Parsnips, Sprouts and Pancetta, Braised Red Cabbage, Sour Dough Bread Sauce, Pigs in Blankets, Sage and Onion Stuffing, Cranberry Sauce, Turkey Gravy OR Portobello Mushroom and Chestnut Wellington, Tarragon Sauce. Christmas Pudding with Clotted Cream.

To be collected on Christmas Eve with full re heating instructions!

Tuesday Theme Nights are - 9th December - Tapas Night 23rd December - Christmas Menu 6th January - Steak Night 20th January - Curry Night 27th January - Pizza Night.

We will be closing on Wednesday evenings in January through to April. The Pub up Shop opening hours continue to be the same as the pub. We try to keep the website up to date but if unsure please give us a call.

CHRISTMAS AND NEW YEAR OPENING TIMES

Monday 22nd December
Closed

Tuesday 23rd December
11.30am - 11.00pm

Christmas Eve
11.00am - 1.00pm

Boxing Day
Closed

Friday 27th December
4.00pm - 11.00pm
Kitchen 5.30pm - 8.30pm

Saturday 28th December
Open as Usual

Sunday 29th December
Open as Usual

Monday 30th December
Closed

New Years Eve
11.30am - 8.00pm
Kitchen open 12.00pm - 6.00pm

New Years Day
12.00pm - 6.00pm
Kitchen open 12.00pm - 4.00pm

Thursday 2nd January
Open as Usual

Friday 3rd January
Open as Usual

Saturday 4th January
Open as Usual

Sunday 5th January
Open as Usual

Lastly, we like to thank all our wonderful customers for their continued support. We wish you all a very Merry Christmas

James, Sarah, Zachary, Lydia and Martha

01363 85273

theduckatyeoford.co.uk

YEOFORD VILLAGE VOICE FUN QUIZ

No prizes, no pressure...this month...it's Chriiiiiistmas...

1. Which country is credited with starting the tradition of decorating a Christmas tree?
2. In which century were Christmas crackers first invented?
3. In The Muppet Christmas Carol, which Muppet plays Bob Cratchit?
4. In National Lampoon's Christmas Vacation, what kind of animal is found hiding in the Griswold family Christmas tree?
5. What is the name of the villain, played by Alan Rickman, in the all-time best Christmas Movie Die Hard?
6. What was the Christmas Number 1 in the UK Music Charts 2009?
7. Which iconic song was the Christmas Number 1 in both 1975 and 1991?
8. Which song finally reached Christmas Number 1 in December 2023, 39 years after its release?
9. In which country is fried chicken a popular dish to eat on Christmas Day?
10. Which European country is often credited with starting the tradition of hanging stockings by the fireplace for Santa to fill with gifts?

Answers below...

1. Germany; 2. 19th Century; 3. Kermit the Frog; 4. A squirrel; 5. Hans Gruber; 6. Rage Against the Machine—Killing in the Name; 7. Queen—Bohemian Rhapsody; 8. Wham—Last Christmas; 9. Japan; 10. Netherlands

Quiz Answers:

FROM THE PARISH COUNCIL

REPORTING A PROBLEM WITH ROADS TO DEVON COUNTY COUNCIL

All drivers will be aware that state of repair of roads in Crediton Hamlets Parish is appalling, with more and more potholes (or are they craters?) appearing. The lack of action by Devon County Council is exceedingly frustrating but please report potholes in the hope this makes a difference.

Problems with roads can be reported on the Devon County Council website:
www.devon.gov.uk/roads-and-transport/report-a-problem/

There is a link to this page under "Useful Information" on the Parish Council website
www.creditonhamlets.org.uk.

If the pothole has already been reported please add yourself to the existing report so that Devon County Council is aware that another person has reported the problem.



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Crediton Arts Centre News

Thursday 4th

Music and Food Jazz on the Green 7.00pm

Friday 5th

Music The Jeremiahs 7.30pm

Saturday 6th

Crediton Heart Christmas Craft Fair 10.00am-4.00pm

Sunday 7th

Crediton Heart Christmas Craft Fair 10.00am-4.00pm

Friday 12th

THE BIG Christmas Quiz 7.30pm

Thursday 18th

Music Moon Jazz 7.30pm

Friday 19th

Music Solstice Live Lounge 7.30pm

Check the website for more details

www.creditonartscentre.org

Library at the Church

Following the demise of the Mobile Library, alongside the books at the station, there is also now a small library in Yeoford Church and all are welcome to borrow books.



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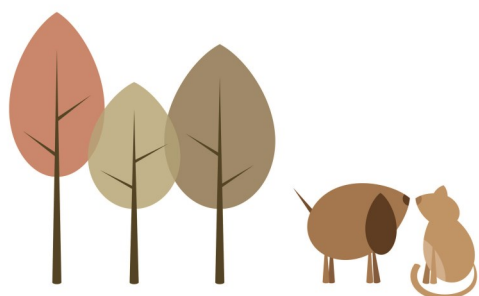
Call or e-mail now to see how Clive
can assist!

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busterandclive@gmail.com

Cover Photo

Fancy getting your picture on the front of the VV? Then send your photos, drawings, musings, or whatever to yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk and there's a good shout it'll appear on the cover!



Orchard End Kennels & Cattery

Black dog, Crediton, EX17 4QE

01363 877371

www.orchardendkennels.co.uk

West Down Chapel Yeoford Road

December

Tuesday 2nd Ladies Bible Study at Venbridge House at 10.30am, Bible Study, Prayer, Tea/Coffee and biscuits, please join us

Sunday 7th Sunday Morning Worship at 11am with Freddie Hawkins.

Wednesday 10th Friends and Neighbours at 2pm

Christmas crafts with tea and biscuits.

Sunday 14th Sunday Morning worship at 11am with David Cole.

Sunday afternoon West Down Carol Service at 3pm

lead by David Cole refreshments at close.

Tuesday 16th Ladies Bible Study at Venbridge House at 10.30am,

Bible Study, Prayer, Tea/Coffee and biscuits, please join us.

Sunday 21st Sunday morning Worship at 11am with John Allan.

Christmas Day Celebration 10.30--11.15 am.

Sunday 28th Sunday Morning Worship at 11am 'Reflectiton'

Contacts:

David Pitts djpitts270@gmail.com
01363 773379

Derek Coren shortacombe@googlemail.com
01647 24264 / 07929858527



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JOKE OF THE MONTH COMPETITION

Two hydrogen atoms meet. One says "I've lost my electron". The other says "Are you sure?". The first replies, "Yes I'm positive."

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YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL— SEEKING COMMUNITY GROUPS!

Yeoford Community Hall has availability for community groups for one-offs or regular bookings on Wednesday evenings, Thursday evenings or Sunday evenings. Exercise classes, craft groups, workshops, educational events or social clubs would be warmly welcomed. Trial periods will be accommodated.

Daytime slots on occasional Tuesdays and Thursdays are also available.

Holy Trinity Church Yeoford

As with all churches we have a very busy December. Starting with our community Christmas Lunch on December 1st. the children make the pudding on stir up Sunday.

Some of the congregation have made pom poms that the children have decorated to go on Holy Trinity tree at the Christmas Tree Festival at Holy Cross.

The Carol Service is on 21st December at 5pm. The Crib Service at 4pm and the Holy Communion for Christmas 9pm on Christmas Eve.

Café Company Mondays from 10 till 11am except when there is Lunch Club.

Christmas Lunch Club will be on December 1st 12-15 for 12-30pm.

Services in December
Sunday 14th December
Holy Communion 9-30 am
Sunday 21st December
Candle lit Carol Service
5pm

Christmas Eve
Crib Service at 4pm
Holy Communion 9pm

May I wish you all a happy and blessed Christmas.



The Crediton Heart Project

Christmas Craft Fest

6th & 7th December

at Crediton Arts Centre
Christmas creative fun for all!

Workshops: age 16+ £5, under 16s £3

Saturday 6th December

Block Printing

Make your own Christmas cards
& wrapping paper
10am-1pm

Pottery Tree Decorations

Cut out and decorate shapes
to hang on your tree
2-5pm

Sunday 7th December

Yule Log Decorations

Create Yule log decorations
10am -1pm

Wreaths and Mini Trees

Make wreaths for your doors and
mini trees for your table
2-5pm

and a **FREE** Christmas film for all ages

A MUPPET CHRISTMAS CAROL

Saturday 6th December 6pm for a 6.30pm start

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drinks before the film



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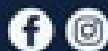
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YEO!CIDER 2025—SATURDAY 18TH OCTOBER

In mid October, later than usual, the community hall hosted the 14th annual cider festival.

Cider drinkers arrive later than ale drinkers, we've discovered over the years, but by 4pm the community hall was buzzing with villagers and day trippers (including a parrot!), eager to sample from a selection of 15 ciders, with wonderful names like Tutti Frutti from Celtic Marches, and 'Slack Ma Girdle' from Sandford Orchards. The cider voted best at the festival by our



YEO! CIDER Champion Cider 2025

1. **THISTLY CROSS – WHISKY CASK**
2. **SAMS – CRISP CIDER**
3. **RIDGE & FURROW – NATURALLY MEDIUM SWEET**



dubious squad of official tasters was Whisky Cask from Thistly Cross. Scottish whisky casks are used to give this cider warming notes of oak, vanilla and honey. YUM!

Drinkers were treated to music from Rob Murch, Jason Rice and Bernie Samuel, plus our own homegrown band, Yeo Division in the evening.

Thank you to all our sponsors who make the day possible, including SJ Willis & Sons, South West Galvanisers, Yellow Mouse Studios, Fargo Systems, The Duck at Yeoford,

Yoga Esme, Just Gels, Wild Earth Tattooing, New Inn at Coleford, Paint Pots of Devon, Pool n Spa Services, Crediton Milling Company, The Copper Key at North Tawton, Devon Tree Services, The Beer Engine and SimpkinsEdwards. Particular thanks go to the Tom Cobley Tavern at Spreyton for sponsoring the glasses, and to Rick Partridge for designing our logo.



All in all,
another
successful
festival, adding
around £1000 to
the community
hall and
recreation
ground coffers.
Festival money
lately has been
used to
purchase a new
shed, improve



the heating system and will be used to replace the fence around the
playground as well as keeping hire charges low for our regular user groups.

Finally – thank you to all our volunteers. You know who you are. You help
make this village an absolute pleasure to live in and we couldn't do it
without you.

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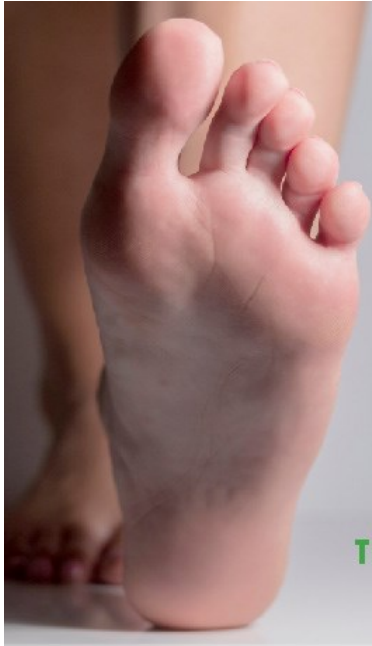
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@CREDITON MUSEUM: 6PM - 7PM

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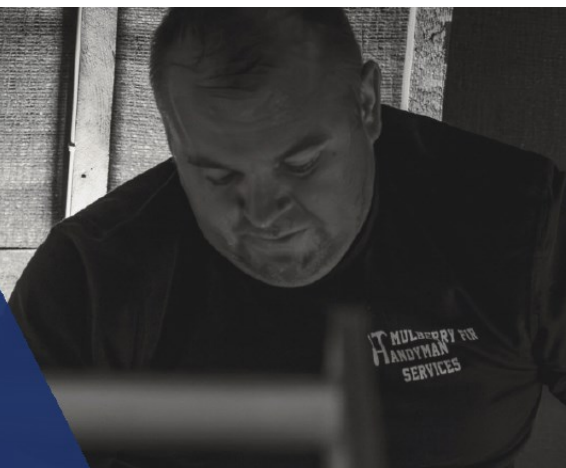
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- ✓ Room wall panelling
- ✓ Odd jobs around the house

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CREDITON HAMLETS PARISH COUNCIL

At the November Parish Council Meeting Councillors were made aware of a crack that has developed in the wall of the bridge over the Yeo in the village and it was agreed that the Clerk should notify the Highways Officer requesting urgent attention to assess and resolve the problem.

Cllr Yarnold updated councillors on progress with spring planting proposals at Yeoford Station.

The Parish was represented at The Remembrance Service at Crediton Parish Church on 9th December by Cllr David & Mrs Parker, Cllr George & Mrs Mortimer and Cllr Andrew & Mrs Cole.

Councillors agreed to sponsor the Christmas Lights competition again for 2025 with prizes for 1st, 2nd and third places with judging starting week commencing 15 December.

The Council usually meets on the first Monday of the month. The next full Council meeting will be on Monday 1st December at Yeoford Community Hall. If you would like to read the full minutes of the October Parish Council meeting they are on the PC website. Please contact one of your councillors or Charlotte Long, the Parish Clerk (clerk@creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk or **01363 84558** if there is something you would like to have discussed at the next Council meeting. Members of public are very welcome to attend any meeting and speak during the public session. Meeting details and contact information for Councillors are on the Parish Council website (www.creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk).

PLEASE READ: AIR AMBULANCE

An appeal to all our villagers

If you, your children or anyone you know plays in the recreation ground please always check with them that they have returned the goals to the edge of the field.

This is because the Air Ambulance **CANNOT LAND** if the goals are in the middle of the field.

If you pass the recreation ground or see anybody playing with the goals in the centre, could you please remind them (politely) that they should be returned to the edge after use, or move them back if you find them abandoned like this.

Thank you all for your cooperation.

Yeoford Community Association



CHRISTMAS LIGHTS COMPETITION

PLEASE HELP MAKE THE YEOFORD WARD LOOK SPECIAL THIS
CHRISTMAS BY DECORATING THE OUTSIDE OF YOUR HOUSE OR
GARDEN



CREDITON HAMLETS PARISH COUNCIL IS SPONSORING A PRIZE
OF A £50 VOUCHER TO SPEND AT THE DUCK FOR THE
HOUSE/GARDEN JUDGED TO BE THE BEST
with CHOCOLATES FOR THE SECOND & THIRD PRIZES



**CLOSING DATE FOR ENTRIES SUNDAY 14 DECEMBER
FOR JUDGING FROM 15 DECEMBER**

To make sure your house is included in the competition or for more information
contact the Parish Clerk, Charlotte Long, on 01363 84558 or

clerk@creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk





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